Excerpt

"True" Mean and Confidence Interval

Probably the most often used descriptive statistic is the mean. The mean is a particularly informative measure of the "central tendency" of the variable if it is reported along with its confidence intervals. As mentioned earlier, usually we are interested in statistics (such as the mean) from our sample only to the extent to which they can infer information about the population. The confidence intervals for the mean give us a range of values around the mean where we expect the "true" (population) mean is located (with a given level of certainty, see also Elementary Concepts). For example, if the mean in your sample is 23, and the lower and upper limits of the p=.05 confidence interval are 19 and 27 respectively, then you can conclude that there is a 95% probability that the population mean is greater than 19 and lower than 27. If you set the p-level to a smaller value, then the interval would become wider thereby increasing the "certainty" of the estimate, and vice versa; as we all know from the weather forecast, the more "vague" the prediction (i.e., wider the confidence interval), the more likely it will materialize. Note that the width of the confidence interval depends on the sample size and on the variation of data values. The larger the sample size, the more reliable its mean. The larger the variation, the less reliable the mean (see also Elementary Concepts).

8.5 Business Organisation

The curriculum for Business Organisation is somewhat similar to that of Management. Web sites in the *Management* chapter will also help you with this topic.

8.5.1. Mary Hogue's Lecture Presentations

http://www.personal.kent.edu/~mhogue/Pof%20Management.htm
http://www.personal.kent.edu/~mhogue/HRM.htm
http://www.personal.kent.edu/~mhogue/I&GBehavior.htm

Mary Hogue of Kent State University has presented the syllabus of Principles of Management as PowerPoint Presentation files, where